DAY 03 / 11 · WEB DEV IN 11 DAYS · GUIDED

Lay out the home page

Flexbox, Grid and phones: where things go

ShowShelf after today: **the home page layout: a top bar, a search bar and a grid of show cards**

TODAY

The plan for the next 90 minutes

Minutes	Topic
10	Recap of Day 2
7	Boxes inside boxes: the container
16	Flexbox: a row
7	Grow and centre
12	Grid: rows and columns
13	Mobile first: media queries
5	Cards that lift
5	The big idea, and questions
15	This afternoon in the Lab

RECAP · DAY 2

Five quick questions

1. h1 { color: #5b3fd6; } Selector, property, value?
2. Why does background-colour do nothing?
3. How do you select every class="meta"?
4. The four layers of the box model, inside out?
5. Where are your own colours, and how do you use one?

LAYOUT · STEP 1

Boxes inside boxes

base.css: colours, fonts, the look of each card. No layout.

layout.css: where things go. That's yours today.

.container: max-width, margin 0 auto, padding at the sides. Used twice, one rule.

```
<header class="site-header">
  <div class="container header-inner">
    <a class="logo">ShowShelf</a>
    <nav class="nav">…</nav>
  </div>
</header>
<main class="container">
  <section class="hero">…</section>
  <section class="shows-section">
    <div class="grid">
      <article class="card">…</article>
      …
    </div>
  </section>
</main>
```

FLEXBOX · STEP 2

display: flex makes a row

Put it on the **parent**. Its direct children, the flex items, line up in a row.

parent: .card-body

badge | h3 | rating | meta

```
.card-body {
  display: flex;
}

/* not on a child: */
.badge {
  display: flex;
}
/* nothing moves */
```

The Flexbox properties you need

Property	Common values	Does
`display`	flex	Children in a row
`justify-content`	center, space-between	Along the row
`align-items`	center	Across the row
`gap`	12px	Space between items
`flex`	1 (on a child)	Grow into the free space

The first four go on the **parent**. Spelling: **center**, not centre.

FLEXBOX · STEPS 5–6

flex: 1 takes the free space

Parent: **display: flex**. The child that grows: **flex: 1**.



text-align: center on a parent centres all the text inside.

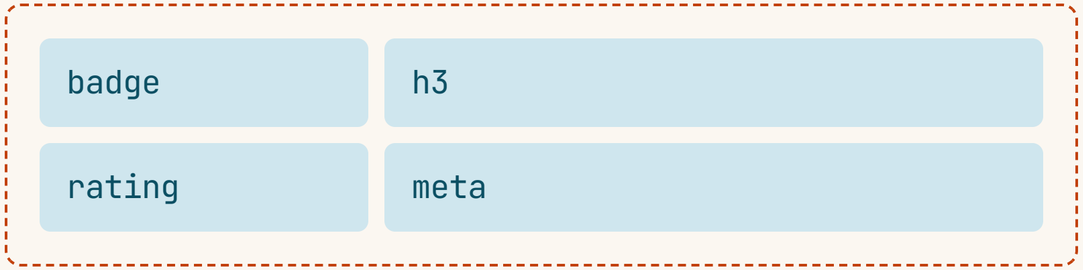
```css
.card-body {
  display: flex;
  gap: 12px;
}

/* an h3 inside .card-body */
.card-body h3 {
  flex: 1;
}
```

GRID · STEP 7

Grid: rows and columns

fr: a fraction of the free space. **1fr 2fr**: the second column is twice as wide.




```
.card-body {
  display: grid;
  grid-template-columns:
    1fr 2fr;
  gap: 12px;
}

/* repeat(2, 1fr)
   is 1fr 1fr */
```

GRID · STEP 8

Same shape, every picture

aspect-ratio: the shape. Width first, then height.

object-fit: cover: fills the shape and cuts the edges. With **fill**, a photo gets stretched.

Real posters arrive in all sizes later in the course. This keeps every card the same.

```
.poster {
  width: 100%;
  aspect-ratio: 1 / 1;
  object-fit: fill;
}

/* now try: cover */
```

RESPONSIVE · STEPS 9–10

Mobile first: phones, then bigger

Screen	Grid columns
phones (normal rules)	2
600px and up	3
900px and up	4

Preview not changing? Press **Bigger** and resize the window.

```
@media (min-width: 700px) {
  .hero h1 {
    color: crimson;
  }
}

@media (min-width: 1000px) {
  .hero h1 {
    color: teal;
  }
}
/* small to big: biggest last */
```

EFFECTS · STEP 11

Smooth little moves

transform moves or resizes, without pushing the neighbours. **translateY(-4px)**: up, because minus is up.

transition on the normal rule: smooth on the way in and on the way out.

```
button {
  transition: transform 0.2s;
}

button:hover {
  transform: scale(1.1);
}
```

LAYOUT RULE

The parent decides where its children go.

THIS AFTERNOON IN THE LAB

Eleven steps to the home page

Top bar

1 A centred container

2 Flexbox: a row

3 Logo left, menu right

4 Space between the menu links

Hero, search

5 The hero: centred text

6 A search bar that stretches

The grid

7 Grid: cards in columns

8 Posters that fill the card

Bigger screens

9 Phones first, then bigger screens

10 A second breakpoint for laptops

11 Cards that lift

Milestone: a flex top bar, a stretching search bar and a grid of 2, 3, then 4 columns

Finished early? Extra challenges B1 to B3: a sticky top bar, six columns on big screens, a grid without media queries.

STUCK? IN THIS ORDER

Message, Console, hint, answer, ask

1

Message

Read the “Not yet” message. It says what to fix.

2

Console

Under the preview: click its title bar. Red lines name the problem and the line.

3

Hint

Two per step. The second is nearly the answer.

4

Answer

Compare it with yours. Find the difference.

5

Ask

The teacher, or the person next to you.

END OF THE DAY

Can you answer these?

1. Logo and menu in a row: which box gets display: flex?
2. What does repeat(2, 1fr) make?
3. 3 columns at 600px, but the preview shows 2. Broken?

TOMORROW

JavaScript: first steps

Your first instructions for the browser: values, variables, a little maths, and a page that fills itself in.